

Rulebook 0.0.2 (Pre-Alpha)

What is an Entity?

Health

Each Entity will have the health component base class that governs the well being of any being, from living to non-living (see the "Health component" section in the "How will we make it?" tab for more details"). The health component class consists of multiple individual limbs and portions (e.g. arms, legs, chest, head), with each having the ability to sustain damage and be affected by the several damage types (see "damage types" in "things" for more details).

In tandem to damage, status effects can also be incurred and affect the health component positively or negatively (see "Status effects" in "Things"). Accumulated damage to a body part can hinder its effective use and even put it out of action entirely. Being injured, depending on the type of injury, for the most part will cause a severity of the "pain" status effect to be triggered, and in some cases a severity of "blood loss". Sustaining severe damage and or a critical severity status effect can put a character out of action or even kill them outright if left unchecked.

Health components are also defined as being connected to other health components. Your hand is connected to your arm, so if your arm is severed, your hand is lost with it.

Lastly, one health component is defined as the "Head". If the head is separated from the body, the entity dies. If an entity has multiple heads, it must lose all heads to die.

Entity Sizes

Entities will be categorized into 5 main sizes: Miniscule, Small, Average, Large, and Gargantuan. The size of the entity affects the level of blood loss that they can incur before experiencing the "Devastating Pain" status effect. Another aspect of the Entity that is affected is the difficulty of each health component to hit, larger entities will be easier to hit and smaller entities will be harder to hit.

Cases:

- human
- wolf
- bat
- giraffe
- bumblebee

Statures:

- grounded

- Can attack lower body
- low
 - can attack lower body, middle body
- humanoid
 - can attack lower body, middle, upper
- Big
 - can attack middle, upper, elevated
- Super Big
 - too big to target individual body parts.

Body regions:

- Lower body
 - Includes anything at the pelvis and below
- Middle body
 - above Pelvis to the neck (not included)
- Upper Body
 - Neck and above (for humans)
- Elevated body
 - Head for Giraffes & Entities of abnormally large sizes

consider: targeting (how hard to hit body parts), and aiming difficulty (how hard is it for this thing to hit body parts)

Body part difficulties [Size: Miniscule]

Impossible
Ears
Eyes
Fingers (Hand)
Toes
Legs
Arms
Head
Neck
Upper Torso
Lower torso

Body part difficulties [Size: Small]

Impossible	Iffy	Normal
Ears	Legs	Upper Torso
Eyes	Arms	Lower torso
Fingers (Hand)	Head	
Toes	Neck	

Body part difficulties [Size: Average]

Impossible	Iffy	Normal
Ears	Legs	Upper Torso
Eyes	Arms	Lower torso
Fingers (Hand)	Head	
Toes	Neck	

Body part difficulties [Size: Large]

Impossible	Iffy	Normal
Ears	Legs	Upper Torso
Eyes	Arms	Lower torso
Fingers (Hand)	Head	
Toes	Neck	

Body part difficulties [Size: Gargantuan]

Impossible	Iffy	Normal
Ears	Legs	Upper Torso
Eyes	Arms	Lower torso
Fingers (Hand)	Head	

Toes	Neck
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What is a Character?

Traits

Traits work alongside or against a character depending on the trait and how a player utilizes it (see "Traits" in "Things" for details). They are part of the backbone that defines who your character is and where they stand in the world. Traits are split into 3 sub-trait classes: personality, skill, and intrinsic. The first 2 are traits that are manipulated through interactions with others and the environment, the last of which can only be effected through major events or quest lines.

Equipment

Inventory

Base inventory will be 5 rows of 6 columns (5 X 6) for a total of 30 slots to store items. Items that are stored in the inventory will not be stackable, but all items regardless of size will take up 1 inventory slot (the good old 10 pianos in the back pocket trick).

Equipping Gear

Special gear can increase slots for unique items. Examples:

- Triple sheath belt: Allows you to hold 3 sword
- Grenades bandolier: allows you to hold (like 6 or so idk bro...) grenades
- Backpack: allows you to hold (like 18 - 20 or so) more items
- Satchel: Grants (like 4 - 10) inventory slots, items from it can be used just as quick as if they were in your hand
- Purse: Not a lot of storage space, but may allow your to sneak its contents into restricted places if you are a female

Equipping Weapons

You can either single wield a weapon or dual wield a weapon as long as you have 2 working hands. Switching weapons (depending on the weapon) consumes an extra action. Weapons that are stored in special holding containers (e.g. sheath, purse, rifle sling, pistol holster, Grenade bandolier, ect.) will not consume any action to switch and utilize.

Ammunition

Ammo for weapons will operate on a “create/box” of ammo system, ammo containers can be found in various states (e.g. full - half - empty || full - somewhat full - somewhat empty - empty || or however many charges we decided it gives) which determine how many reloads for a weapon the box will give. Switching weapon ammo types in a gun when you are partially through a magazine (one charge of an ammo container) will forfeit that charge of the previous ammo type for the newly loaded ammo type.

Fate

The primary resource of combat is Fate. By leveraging your character's Fate, you can pull off more daring feats- Fate is then, a deterministic measurement of luck.

Your fate meter has four slots. This is often displayed in this rulebook as (_ _ _ _). there are three states one of your fate slots can be in:

- _ Ambiguous
- + Fate
- - Cursed

“Ambiguous” means there is no fate in this slot- it can become positive or negative.

“Fate” is positive, and can be spent for actions. If accumulated, this can lead to

“Cursed” is negative, and if accumulated can lead to Cataclysm.

Sometimes compound notation is used, like (- | _). This means cursed or ambiguous, in that order. for example, if an action turns (- | _) into (+), this will convert a cursed point into a fate point, and if you have no cursed point, only then will it turn ambiguous fate into positive fate.

Actions you take, both inside and outside of combat. Some examples include:

- using a smoke bomb to occlude yourself turns cursed points into ambiguous points.
- shooting someone turns an ambiguous point into a fate point
- being shot turns ambiguous fate into cursed points

notably, ambiguous fate can quickly turn into Fate or cursed points, but it is much more circumstantial that Fate or Cursed points are turned into other points. This means that if you have all four slots defined, your fate may stay static turn-to-turn unless you expend it, for better or worse.

Cataclysm and Miracles

If you obtain four Cursed points (- - - -), you obtain a cataclysm. This can either be exploited by your enemies, or cause an action of your own to backfire.

If someone targets your chest, a cataclysm can cause that bullet to fire right through your heart, instantly putting you into shock. You'll die if you're not... somehow... stabilized in one turn.

Conversely, four fate (+ + + +) points will reward you with a miracle. This can allow your gun to hit a target from much farther away, pull off a far more devastating attack, or counter someone else's devastating attack.

See Appendix A for full item descriptions and how they modify fate, as well as Appendix C for general actions which mutate fate.

Map-modes and combat initiation

Map-modes

There are two modes of gameplay - combat, and neutral-play (Place holder). In combat, the game is turn based. In neutral-play, the game runs in real time. Combat is initiated on a map when either an enemy or the player launches an attack, switching the entire map from neutral-play. A map can only be in a state of combat or a state of neutral-play. If combatants are involved elsewhere on the map, even if the player is not involved, the map will be in combat mode- even if nothing is targeting you, you will obey turn based rules.

Initiating combat

Firing a gun, bow, or attacking with a sword or knife all initiate combat. Combat can also be initiated when entering LOS (Line Of Sight) of an enemy or being attacked by an enemy. Throwing a grenade doesn't inherently bring you into combat. In order for an action to switch a map to combat, it must either attempt to damage someone, or be heard by an interested entity- if you blow up a grenade and only a cow hears it, this will not incite combat as it would have no interest.

If you execute an entity in a single attack without anybody hearing or witnessing, this will not initialize combat.

Turn order

The instigator always goes first. The turn order from there is decided from fate- whoever has the highest fate goes next. (+) counts as 1, (-) counts as -1, and ambiguous fate () counts as 0. In the event of a tie, whoever is closest to the instigator takes priority.

Stealth and sound propagation

All actions create audible sound that can be perceived by all existing entities. There are 3 main factors that affect if a sound is heard, that being: the event that is causing sound, the noise level of the environment and the focus level of any given entity's perception to external noise. These four factors work together constantly to create a unique representation of audio perception

Stealth uses these principles to determine if any entity avoids the detection of others. The system uses a “Silent, Quiet, Noisy, Loud, Deafening” level to describe all sound events. As a base line, all sounds propagate through the entire room if they are the same level or above the current room level. Depending on the properties of the room and adjacent rooms, a sound can bleed into other rooms at a different sound level than its original. Entities are either in a “Fully distracted, Distracted, normal, or Focused” state. The sound level of the room sets the pace for what sounds are perceivable on a base line level. For example, if you are in a library, the noise level is usually quiet. This means that as a base line, noises made that are Quiet and above are perceived by all entities that are normal. Any entity that is distracted will only hear a sound that is Noisy or above, if fully distracted, only Loud sounds and above are perceived. For Focused it goes the opposite way, a focused entity will be able to perceive Silent noises in a Quiet room.

Sound levels:

Silent: Faint noises, like a whisper across the room.

Quiet: more audible but not very significant noises, like footsteps on carpet or the opening of a door.

Noisy: significant noises, like multiple people talking in the same room or walking on creaky floors.

Loud: Very significant sound, like loud music or a gunshot in another room.

Deafening: Extreme noises, like a gunshot or grenade exploding at point blank, or a jet engine.

Listening levels:

Focused: can hear noises 1 level below the sound level of the room

Normal: can hear noises of same sound level as room

Distracted: can hear noises 1 level above the sound level of the room

Fully distracted: can hear noises 2 levels above the sound level of the room

On your turn

Turn composition

A turn will consist of the three components: movement, attack, and then an “extra action”.

- 1st test: You can always complete these three things, in any order.
- 2nd test: Certain extra actions will cause you to forfeit the rest of your turn components

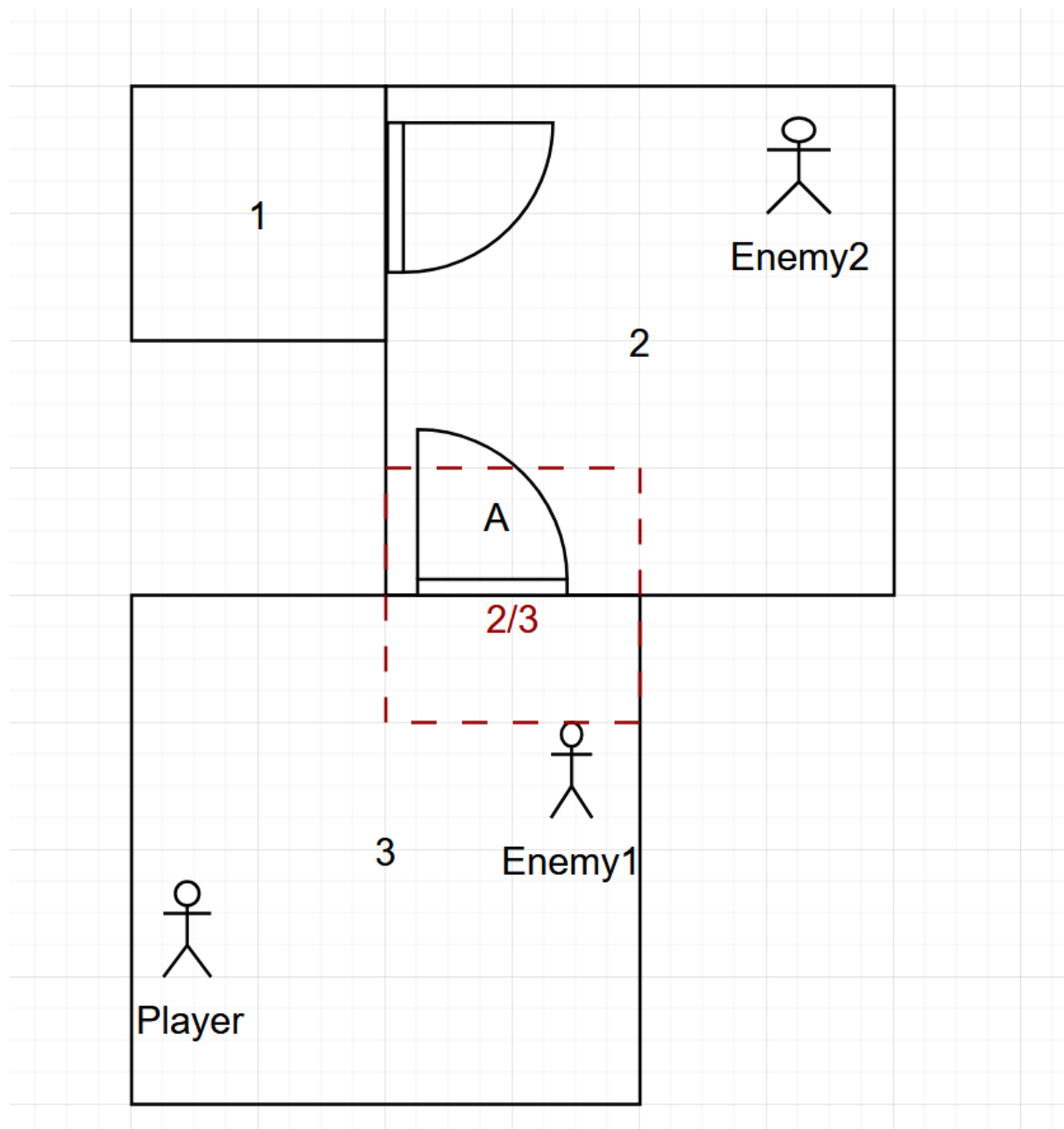
Movement

Example: The player, on their turn, can move to any position in room 3. They can additionally move to room 2, ending their turn in room 2 at the edge between both rooms - position A. This is within the (2/3) zone.

- if the player has a pistol, they can hit enemy1, who is in the same room as them.
- if the player has a rifle, and has line of sight through the doorway, they can hit enemy 1 or enemy 2.

What if the player is inside room 3 but physically very close to an enemy in room 2? Then, the player is considered in the "transition" area of the room, or in 2/3. if you are in 2/3, for the purposes of aiming and attacks, you are considered both in room 3 and in room 2. As a downside, you are also susceptible to attacks from enemies in both room 2 and 3, and a doorway isn't the safest place to be in the world.

sound propagation is also through rooms. With the doors closed, a rifle fired in room 3 can be heard in room 1, while a silenced pistol cannot be heard in room 2.



Attack

allows you to utilize your weapon. See “Aiming” for understanding range mechanics. Barring traits that augment your attack capabilities, you can attack one target within range with your weapon.

Extra action

freedom for players to spin the battle in their favor, it is a turn that allows the character to utilize their skills, render medical aid, or read a book (if they really wanted to). The only thing that a player may NOT do on this extra turn is launch a direct attack on an opponent. An indirect attack (e.g. a grenade, molotov) is permitted on the extra action. Depending on a plates skills/traits, they can utilize the extra action to attempt unique interactions:

- A medic/doctor may be able to use their extra action to render advanced medical aid (field surgery)
- Someone who is blood thirsty may be able to attack again with their extra action
- A Soldier may be able to use a unique skill with auto-rifles that allows them to consume both their attack and extra action to rapid fire the rifle
- Etc

Aiming

Aiming focuses on three main different tiers of difficulty “Impossible, Iffy, and Normal” these levels are dynamic to what you are aiming at and the subjective difficulty of the attack. For example, attempting to snipe someone's eye out is going to be an impossible difficulty of an attack to attempt. On the contrary, attempting to stab someone in the chest is going to be a normal difficulty strike, because the chest is so large, it's kinda hard to miss.

Body part difficulties (Human) [Size: Average]

Impossible	Iffy	Normal
Ears	Legs	Upper Torso
Eyes	Arms	Lower torso
Fingers (Hand)	Head	
Toes	Neck	

Difficulty of a shot strike	Ranged	Melee
Impossible	(+ + + +) -> (_ _ _ _)	(+ +) -> (_ _)
Iffy	(+ +) -> (_ _)	(+) -> (_)
Normal	Free	Free

Reaction shot

If you ready a reaction shot at the end of your turn, you can expend fate to hit targets which move in front of your vision. if you ready a reaction shot without any fate, you will fire, but you will miss.

If you are the target of a reaction shot, regardless of whether it hits or not, will suppress your movement, stopping you in your tracks for the rest of your turn, unless you have a perk which allows you to continue moving.

Difficulty of a shot strike	Ranged	Melee
Impossible	(+ + + +) -> (_ _ _ _)	(+ + +) -> (_ _)
Iffy	(+ +) -> (_ _)	(+ +) -> (_)
Normal	(+) -> (_)	(+) -> (_)

Body part	Priority
Lower Torso	1
Upper Torso	2
Left Leg	3
Right Leg	4
Left Arm	5
Right Arm	6
Head	7
Neck	8
Left Foot	9
Right Foot	10
Left hand	11
Right Hand	12
Left eye	13
Right eye	14
Left ear	15

Getting hit

an attack on your body which is not defied or ablated will result in an injury. Different injuries incur different statuses.

Light (bleeding) injuries:

- small caliber
- buckshot
- light slicing wound

Light (non-bleeding) injuries:

- light impact wound

Heavy (bleeding) injuries:

- large caliber
- heavy slicing wound
- heavy stabbing wound
- devastating impact wound

Heavy (non-bleeding) injuries:

- heavy impact wound

Light injuries will produce minor blood loss at the end of your turn, and contribute minor pain.

heavy injuries will produce significant blood loss at the end of your turn, and contribute significant pain.

Upon getting hit for the first time, you will receive amped x2. you lose 1x amped at the end of every term.

Entities have the ability to fall down gaining the “Downed” status effect, this causes all of their health components to move down from the current body level to the next lower body level if available. e.g : if a human is downed their head would move from the Upper body to the Middle body, and anything in the Middle body would move to the Lower body. Depending on how you were knocked down determines if you can get back up, if there is severe structural damage to the legs you will not be able to get up, if it is a physical attack (kick/takedown) as long as you are not being pinned, you may get back up.

Combat end

Combat ends when only one party of the engagement consists of entities capable of completing actions on their turn. If a fight is between group A and group B, combat ends if, for example, all members of group B are disabled (enter shock or otherwise go unconscious) or killed.

If a single member of the player party is killed, under NALB (No Ally Left Behind) rules this is considered a gameover and the encounter must be retried. Otherwise, the remaining players may continue. If all members of the player party are killed or disabled, this is considered a game over if the assailing entities are attacking with intent to kill. If the assailants are attacking with the intent to disable, ending combat with all players unconscious ends combat but has the players wake up elsewhere, likely with injuries.

Appendix A: Items

Disposable items

Throwables:

- Smoke bomb
 - Produces smoke around the bomb. Smoke can be walked through but cannot be seen through.
 - breaking visibility with a smoke bomb turns one (-) into (+) for every enemy whose Line of sight is broken
 - Ending turn within smoke will inflict minor asphyxiation.
- Fragmentation Grenade
 - Fate-checks all living things within line of sight of detonation. if the attack is not defied:
 - if you have (+ + + +), a miracle occurs, and you take no damage.
 - If you have (+ + +), it turns into (-) and inflicts damage to legs.
 - if you have (+ +), it turns into (- -) and inflicts damage to the body.
 - if you have (+), it turns into (- - -) and inflicts damage to the head.
 - All living things within the same room without any ear protection are inflicted with deafness (temporary).
- fate is preserved if the body defies or ablates the fragments.

Medical:

- Hemostatic Syringe
 - Stops bleeding from **buckshot**, **small caliber**, and **large caliber** injuries.
- Painkillers
 - prevents minor pain from turning to significant pain for 1 turn.
- Epipen
 - Induces amped for 2 turns.
- Superglue
 - Stops bleeding from **light stabbing** and **light slicing** injuries.
- Blood transfusion
 - Removes **significant blood loss**, or **all minor blood loss**.

misc:

- armor plate
 - up to 3 can be put into a plate carrier. ablates when shot.
- 9mm ammo box
 - can reload a 9mm caliber gun
 - goes from full -> half empty -> empty (gone)
- 7.62 ammo box
 - can reload a 7.62 caliber gun
 - goes from full -> half empty -> empty (gone)

Weapons

Combat knife

- Allows you to perform a light stabbing or light slicing attack.
- silent, provided your target does not scream.
- spending (+) allows you to perform an execution if performed from behind undetected

9mm pistol

- Allows you to perform a small caliber attack.
- can attack targets within range of 2 rooms.
- incurs a (+) fate cost to all targeting if fired with one hand.
- 6 round magazine, single fire

7.62 assault rifle

- allows you to perform a large caliber attack.
- cannot be fired with one hand.
- unscoped - can attack targets in range of 3 rooms.
- 12 round magazine, burst fire (3 rounds) .
 - can expend (+ +) to ensure more than one bullet hits. expending (+ + + +) ensures all three bullets hit.

Equipment

Backpack

- added 12 additional inventory slots to your character. cannot be accessed in combat without spending your extra action to take your backpack off, and then another extra action to access it like a chest.
- significant loading on chest

Side-bag

- adds 6 additional slots that can be accessed directly during an extra action.
- minor loading on chest

grenade bandolier

- adds 3 grenade slots that can be accessed directly during an extra action.

- minor loading on chest

plate carrier

- defies light slashing and stabbing attacks, as well as buckshot
- ablates plates to small caliber and large caliber damage
- significant loading on chest

Steel helmet

- defies light and heavy slashing and stabbing attacks, as well as buckshot
- ablates to small caliber bullets
- significant loading on head

padded jeans

- ablates to light slashing and stabbing attacks
- minor loading on legs

Appendix B: Extra Actions

Switch Door:

Allows you to open and close a door.

Healing:

Allows you to administer aid to yourself (if possible) or others.

Test 1:

On a single Extra Action (EA), you can administer aid to a single health component. For example, if an ally's abdomen has 3 smg rounds in it, you can use superglue on all three wounds within a single EA as all wounds are in the abdomen, stopping bleeding.

Test 2:

On a single EA, you can administer aid to a max of 2 different injuries. For example, if you are shot in your left ankle, torso, and right arm, you can heal any 2 of these gunshot wounds.

Test 3:

On a single EA, you can heal multiple minor injuries, but if you are attempting to heal a more severe injury, you may only resolve one of those. For example if you have 3 large gunshot wounds to your left arm, right arm and left leg and 4 minor gunshot wounds to your right leg. Using your EA, you can either heal all 4 minor gunshot wounds, or one of the large gunshot wounds.

Appendix C: Passive fate mutators

Space control:

- Blocking an enemy's path to you turns (- | _) into (+). An unlocked door does not constitute blocking an enemy's path.
- Destroying an enemy's cover turns (_) into (+).

Attacks:

- Landing attack turns (_) into (+)
- Defying an attack turns (_) into (+)
- Ablation in response to an attack turns (_) into (+)

- Sustaining minor or significant Injury turns (_) into (-)
- Sustaining devastating injury turns (+ + | + - | _ _) into (- -)

Appendix D: Health component status effects

- Minor blood loss
 - obtaining minor blood loss three times will cause progression to significant blood loss.
- Significant blood loss
 - disables movement.
- Hemorrhagic Shock
 - disables your character entirely.

- Minor Pain
 - tolerable on its own. Obtaining minor pain three times will cause progression to significant pain.
- Significant pain
 - any attack turns ambiguous fate into negative fate. Obtaining significant pain twice will cause progression to devastating pain.

- Devastating pain
 - prevents you from attacking completely.
- Amped
 - Suppresses all significant pain while under the influence of adrenaline. allows you to have significant pain x3, which will reduce to devastating pain when adrenaline wears off.

AI summary

This document outlines the design specifications for Down with the count, a tactical, turn-based game focused on granular health, status effects, and environmental interaction.

- Combat and Turns: Combat transitions the map from real-time to turn-based mode upon attack or detection. The instigator moves first, with subsequent turn order determined by "Fate." Each turn allows for movement, an attack, and an "Extra Action" (used for utility, skills, or non-attack actions). Combat concludes when one party is eliminated or incapacitated.
- Health and Injury: The game utilizes a body-part-based health system (e.g., head, limbs, chest). Each part sustains specific injuries (lacerations, bullet wounds, etc.) that cause status effects like pain, blood loss, or shock. Managing these injuries is central to gameplay; the head is a critical component, and its loss results in death. Healing is restricted to specific, limited extra actions.
- Equipment and Inventory: The design replaces traditional armor slots with a "loading" system, where gear is categorized as Minor, Significant, or Overbearing based on its coverage of health components. Inventory is limited to 30 non-stackable slots, with specialized gear (e.g., backpacks, bandoliers) necessary to increase capacity or accessibility.
- Fate System: Fate is a deterministic luck resource representing four slots that fluctuate between "Cursed" (-) and "Fate" (+) states. Players manipulate Fate through actions; accumulating four Cursed points triggers a catastrophic backfire ("Cataclysm"), while four Fate points grant a tactical advantage ("Miracle").
- Stealth and Movement: The game uses a room-based map system where weapon range is defined by room distance. Stealth is governed by sound propagation, categorized from Silent to Deafening. Sound perception depends on the environment's baseline noise level and the entity's attention (e.g., Focused vs. Distracted).
- Development Approach: Development is data-driven, utilizing hierarchical entity scenes (Entity -> LivingEntity -> Human) and resource-based classes to define health components, injuries, and traits. This structure allows for modularity in entity design and management.